

Cover story | NEW DECADE: GREAT EXPECTATIONS



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8. Rekha Purie with Ranbir Kapoor; 9. Koel Purie with Chopra and Khan; 10. J.J. Singh with wife Anupama Singh and V.P. Malik; 11. Godrej with Kalli Purie

12. Jay Panda with wife Jaggi Panda; 13. Prasoona Joshi with Chris Hughes; 14. Jagdish Khattar, Y.C. Deveshwar and Malvinder Singh



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India's largest hospital chain. The event was crowded with power couples, Jay and Jaggi Panda, Naveen Jindal and his wife along with the young newly married couple Jitin Prasada and wife Neha; she in a baby pink sari and him in a powder blue tie, fresh from their African honeymoon. The honeymoon clearly continues; they slipped out before the dinner was served. The glamour brigade also included social whirlwind Ayesha Thapar, scion of the Thapar Group of Industries who attended every session, Dr Naresh Trehan looking elegant in a bandhgala, while fashion guru J.J. Valaya and Kalyani Chawla made a late entry but made up for it while the

gala evening progressed.

There were, clearly, enough stars to light up the night but the two who really stole the show were Cameron and Rushdie. Here's evidence. A group of Americans were attending a conference in the same hotel, wearing similar badges around their necks. They were walking to their venue when they spotted the television screens scrolling quotes by Cameron and Rushdie. Forgetting about their conference, they tried to enter and almost made it inside before an eagle-eyed INDIA TODAY representative stopped them. The gala dinner of the INDIA TODAY Conclave was obviously the place to be.